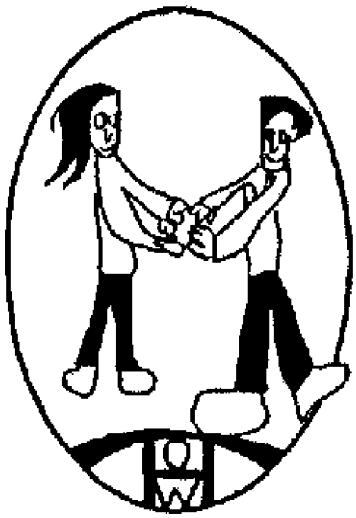
Howbridge Infant School



Safeguarding Policy

September 2025

Safeguarding Policy

Overarching statement

Howbridge Infant School views the safety and welfare of all its children as of paramount importance.

The school recognises that effective child protection work requires sound procedures, good inter-agency cooperation and a workforce that is competent and confident in responding to child protection situations.

At Howbridge Infant school, all children have the right to be safeguarded from harm or exploitation whatever their:

- race, religion, first language or ethnicity
- gender or sexuality
- age
- health or disability
- political or immigration status.

We recognise our legal duty to safeguard all our children under Section 175 Education Act 2002, Children's Act 2004 and *Every Child Matters*, Keeping Children Safe in Education September 2025, *Working Together to Safeguard Children* December 2023, *Safeguarding Children and Safer Recruitment in Education* 2012, Filtering and Monitoring Standards (DfE) 2023, Prevent Duty (HMG) 2024. Our procedures are in accordance with those of the local safeguarding children board.

This policy has been agreed by the governing body and is known to all staff.

Aims and objectives

- Protect children from maltreatment.
- Prevent the impairment of children's health or development.
- Ensure children are growing up in circumstances consistent with the provision of safe and effective care.
- Help children to have optimum life chances and to enter adulthood successfully.
- Endeavour to keep up-to-date and accurate information about all children.
- Enable staff, volunteers and visitors to safeguard and promote the welfare of children.
- Promote a culture that makes this school a safer place to learn.
- Listen to and respect all children.
- Involve children in decisions which affect them.

- Share information about concerns with agencies who need to know, and involve children and their parents/carers appropriately using jargon-free language.
- Recruit staff, volunteers and visitors safely, ensuring all necessary checks are made.
- Adopt a code of conduct for all staff, volunteers and visitors.
- Provide effective management through induction, support and training.
- Deal appropriately with allegations/concerns about staff, volunteers or visitors, in accordance with government guidelines.
- Respect confidentiality in line with the school's confidentiality policy.
- Confront bullying, racism, harassment and discrimination.
- Provide effective first aid from qualified members of staff.
- Meet the needs of pupils with specific medical conditions including ensuring that any intimate care is carried out following agreed guidance and policies.
- Discuss drug and substance misuse.
- Promote internet safety.

Fire Safety and Emergency Planning and Response

The school has a full risk assessment in place and termly fire evacuation practices take place. The fire alarm is tested regularly.

The school has a Lockdown Procedure, Critical Incident Policy, a Business Continuity Plan for Disaster Recovery in the event of a Critical Incident and a school Incident Management Plan. Members of the senior leadership team carry copies of these with them when off the school site.

Safer recruitment and selection

In line with statutory guidance the following will apply for all paid staff and volunteers:

- A DBS enhanced disclosure is obtained for all staff and regular volunteers.
- The school holds an up-to-date single central record detailing a range of checks carried out on staff including identity checks.
- All new appointments who have lived outside the UK will be subject to additional checks as appropriate.
- If volunteer parents accompany children on school visits, they are fully supervised by a member of staff at all times and not left alone with children.
- When recruiting new staff there is at least one member of staff who has received up-to-date safer recruitment training.
- The DSL or Headteacher regularly review the Single Central Record to ensure all updates and checks are completed and are updated efficiently

Supervision of Volunteers/Visitors

For all volunteers who are working with children, where there is no requirement to obtain a DBS certificate, the school will ensure that the volunteer will be supervised by a person who is in regulated activity and who has been DBS checked. The supervision will be regular and day to day and will be at the same level each time the volunteer is in school and will not reduce in quantity or quality.

The supervision will be reasonable and will be structured so that a DBS checked person in regulated activity will have responsibility for the volunteer during the visit/activity. The volunteer will be monitored by the allocated member of staff at all times.

Safe practice

Safe working practice ensures that pupils are safe and that all staff:

- are responsible for their own actions and behaviour and should avoid any conduct which would lead any reasonable person to question their motives and intentions.
- work in an open and transparent way.
- work with other colleagues where possible in situations open to question.
- discuss and/or take advice from school management over any incident which may give rise to concern.
- record any incidents or decisions made.
- apply the same professional standards regardless of gender, religion, ethnicity, ability or sexuality.
- are aware of the confidentiality policy.
- are aware that breaches of the law and other professional guidelines could result in criminal or disciplinary action being taken against them.

Safeguarding information for pupils

The pupils in our school are aware of a number of staff who they can trust and talk to and are available to them at any time. Their first point of contact is usually their class teacher.

Howbridge Infant School is committed to ensuring that pupils are aware of behaviour towards them that is not acceptable and how they can keep themselves safe. They know who they can go to for help.

We inform pupils of their right to be listened to and heard and what steps can be taken to protect them from harm. We use PSHE materials, including our school

scheme ‘Jigsaw’,our school core and British values, circle time and e-safety sessions to help pupils learn how to keep safe.

Partnership with parents

The school shares a purpose with parents to educate and keep children safe from harm and to have their welfare promoted.

We are committed to working with parents positively, openly and honestly. We respect parents' rights to privacy and confidentiality and will not share sensitive information unless we have permission or it is necessary to do so in order to protect a child.

Howbridge Infant School will share with parents any concerns we may have about their child unless to do so may place a child at risk of harm.

Partnership with others

Howbridge Infant School recognises that it is essential to establish positive and effective working relationships with other agencies. There is a joint responsibility on all agencies to share information to ensure the safeguarding of all children.

School training and staff induction

The school's senior designated child protection staff attend child protection Level 3 training and refresher training at two-yearly intervals, they also attend termly network meetings/updates. All other school staff, including non-teaching staff, undertake training annually and updates are given throughout the year when appropriate.

All staff are provided with a range of safeguarding policies on induction. These include the school's Child Protection Policy, Relationships and Behaviour Policy, Staff Code of Conduct, the school’s response to children who go missing from education, the role of the DSL and new staff are informed of the school's child protection arrangements.

Temporary staff and volunteers are made aware of the school's arrangements for child protection, and of their responsibilities. They are informed of the designated Child Protection Staff – currently the SENCo/Deputy head (DSL), the Headteacher and the EYFS Leader (both deputy DSLs)..

Children missing from education

Where children on roll at Howbridge Infant School do not attend the school will attempt to make contact with all of the named pupil’s contacts. If further support

is needed the school will make enquiries through the Attendance Compliance Team and/or the police.

Confidentiality

This section is cross-referenced to the school's confidentiality policy.

Pupil information

Howbridge Infant School will keep up to date and accurate information in order to keep children safe and provide appropriate care for them, including:

- names and contact details of persons with whom the child normally lives.
- names and addresses of all persons with parental responsibility (where given).
- emergency contact details which are updated termly.
- details of any persons authorised to collect the child from school.
- any relevant court orders in place including those which affect any person's access to the child.
- a child who is or has been the subject of a child protection plan.
- name and contact details of GP.
- any other factors which may impact on the safety and welfare of the child.

Children not collected

Where children are left on school site and not collected, the school will endeavour to contact the emergency contact numbers held on file for the child concerned. If the child is still left on site the police will be notified in the first instance.

Children leaving school premises without permission

In the event of a child going missing from the school premises staff will follow at a safe distance whilst the parents will be notified. In the event of the parents not being available the police would be informed.

Children in need

A child in need may have additional needs where their health, development or achievement may be adversely affected. In these cases practitioners will attend regular meetings and a plan will be implemented to support the family. The school will involve other services as appropriate.

Children with a disability

Research shows that disabled children may be at greater risk of abuse and need to be safeguarded on an equal basis to other children. The school will ensure that disabled pupils can access school trips, sports facilities and after school clubs. The school will promote positive attitudes towards children with a disability.

Child protection

Responding to disclosure

Disclosures or information may be received from pupils, parents or other members of the public. School recognises that those who disclose such information may do so with difficulty, having chosen carefully to whom they speak.

Accordingly all staff will handle disclosures with sensitivity. Such information cannot remain confidential and staff will immediately communicate what they have been told to the designated person and make, date and sign a written record.

Staff will not investigate but will, wherever possible, elicit enough information to pass on to the designated person in order that she can make an informed decision of what to do next.

Staff will:

- listen to and take seriously any disclosure or information that a child may be at risk of harm.
- try to ensure that the person disclosing does not have to speak to another member of school staff.
- clarify the information.
- try to keep questions to a minimum and of an ‘open' nature.
- try not to show signs of shock, horror or surprise.
- not express feelings or judgements regarding any person alleged to have harmed the child.
- explain sensitively to the person that they have a responsibility to refer the information to the senior designated person.
- reassure and support the child as far as possible.
- explain that only those who ‘need to know' will be told.

All information and actions taken, including the reasons for any decisions made, will be fully documented.

All referrals to social care will be accompanied by a standard referral form.

Action following a child protection referral
The designated senior person will:

- make regular contact with the social worker involved to stay informed.
- wherever possible, contribute to the strategy discussion.
- provide a report for, attend and contribute to any subsequent child protection conference.
- if the child or children are made subject to a child protection plan, contribute to the plan and attend core group meetings and review child protection conferences.
- where possible, share all reports with parents prior to meetings.
- where in disagreement with a decision made, discuss this with the safeguarding officer for education or the manager of the child protection unit.
- where a child who has a child protection plan moves from the school or goes missing, immediately inform the key worker in children's social care.

E-safety

- To make pupils aware of the dangers of the internet through curriculum teaching particularly PSHE and sex education as age appropriate and by having an e-safety committee including staff and a pupil representative from each class..
- Software is in place in school to minimise access to inappropriate sites.
- Pupils will be encouraged to discuss openly their use of technology and anything which makes them feel uncomfortable. If this results in child protection concerns the school's designated safeguarding lead should be informed immediately.
- Pupils should not give out their personal details, phone numbers, schools, home address or computer passwords.
- Pupils should adhere to the school policy that no mobile phones are allowed.
- The police will be involved if there is any criminal element to misuse of the internet, phones or any other form of electronic media.

Allegations against a professional
Howbridge Infant School understands that children can be the victims of abuse by those who work with them in any setting. All allegations of abuse will be taken seriously.

Where there is an allegation that a professional has: behaved in a way that has harmed a child or may have harmed a child; possibly committed a criminal offence against or related to a child; or has behaved towards a child or children in a way that indicates he/she is unsuitable to work with children the allegations will be investigated properly and in line with agreed procedures (refer to the Whistleblowing section of the Child Protection Policy)

Monitoring and recording
Accurate records will be made as soon as practicable and will clearly distinguish between observation, fact, opinion and hypothesis. All records will be signed and dated, any information will be recorded verbatim where possible and a note made of the location and description of any injuries seen.

All child protection documents will be retained in a ‘child protection' file for hard copies of documents and on a secure computer based file in CPOMs, both are separate from the child's curriculum file. Such files will be kept securely. These records will be transferred to any school or setting the child moves to and a receipt will be received as evidence of collection. Once the receipt has been received all copies of documents will be destroyed.

If the child goes missing from education, or is removed from roll to be educated at home, then any child protection file will be sent to the Local Authority.

To be reviewed: September 2026